Category Policy Addendum: Sports & Outdoors

KARTWAY OPERATIONAL POLICY ADDENDUM Category: Sports & Outdoors (Department 42) Document ID: KW-SOP-42-REV4 Effective Date: 14 January 2025 Applies To: All Tier 1, Tier 2, and Escalated Support Agents

1.0 RETURN WINDOW MODIFICATIONS 1.1 Notwithstanding the standard 30-day marketplace return window set forth in `KW-POL-101`, the return window for all items listed under the Sports & Outdoors category is strictly 45 calendar days from the verified delivery date. 1.2 Return requests initiated on Day 46 or later shall be automatically rejected by the customer support portal without exception, unless the item falls under Section 5.0 (Warranty Claims).

2.0 CATEGORY-SPECIFIC CONDITION REQUIREMENTS 2.1 Field Testing Threshold: Items that show minor cosmetic scuffs consistent with a single session of outdoor testing (such as grass stains on cleat soles or chalk residue on climbing carabiners) are eligible for return, provided total use time does not exceed 4 hours. 2.2 Wear and Tear Exclusions: Items exhibiting structural denting, frame bending, deep gouges in composite materials, or salt-water corrosion shall be rejected upon receipt at the Kartway Returns Processing Center (KRPC). 2.3 Safety-Critical Gear: Climbing harnesses, dynamic ropes, bicycle helmets, and personal flotation devices (PFDs) are subject to a zero-tolerance inspection policy. Any such item returned must show zero evidence of load-bearing stress, impact, or buckle deformation.

3.0 ORIGINAL PACKAGING MANDATES 3.1 Original manufacturer packaging (boxes, molded blister packs, and branded sleeve inserts) is mandatory for all electronics (e.g., cycling computers, GPS units, marine radios) and high-value optics (e.g., binoculars, telescopic rifle scopes). 3.2 For non-electronic goods (e.g., tents, sleeping bags, yoga mats), original packaging is preferred but not mandatory, provided the item is returned in a secure cardboard carton preventing transit damage. 3.3 Missing electronic packaging or damaged optical storage cases shall result in a mandatory packaging remediation fee applied per Section 4.0.

4.0 RESTOCKING FEES AND DEDUCTIONS 4.1 A standard restocking fee of 12% of the purchase price shall be deducted from the customer refund for all opened non-defective items returned within the 45-day window. 4.2 For items returned with missing secondary accessories (e.g., tent stakes, pump adapters, or replacement fin screws), a fixed parts replacement fee of $18.50 shall be deducted in addition to the restocking fee. 4.3 Restocking fees are waived only if the return reason is categorized as "Item Defective Upon Arrival" or "Incorrect Item Shipped by Merchant."

5.0 HAZARDOUS, PRESSURIZED, AND PERISHABLE HANDLING 5.1 Pressurized Cylinders: Camping stove fuel canisters, CO2 bicycle inflator cartridges, and avalanche airbag compressed gas cylinders are strictly non-returnable via standard postal carriers if opened or discharged. If unopened and sealed in original hazardous-materials transport packaging, they may be returned subject to a mandatory hazardous processing inspection. 5.2 Perishable Outdoor Nutrition: Energy gels, electrolyte drink mixes, and freeze-dried expedition meals carry a strict 14-day return window from delivery and must be unopened with safety seals intact. Expired nutritional products shall be disposed of immediately upon receipt with no refund issued. 5.3 Bear Sprays and Pepper Gels: Self-defense bear deterrent sprays cannot be accepted for return if the safety clip is broken or the canister actuation seal is compromised, due to Department of Transportation hazardous waste regulations.

6.0 WARRANTY PERIODS AND MANUFACTURER REDIRECTION 6.1 Kartway provides a direct-pass-through limited warranty handling period of 90 days from the date of purchase for all mechanical and structural defects in Sports & Outdoors items. 6.2 For claims arising between Day 91 and the expiration of the manufacturer's stated warranty (or a maximum of 2 years for branded tents and frames), support agents must direct the buyer to the third-party merchant or original equipment manufacturer (OEM) service center, providing the customer with escalation template `TPL-WR-902`. 6.3 Carbon fiber bicycle frames and composite ski laminates are explicitly excluded from Kartway-administered warranty claims after Day 90; all such claims must go directly through the authorized brand distributor.